women's security and deeper issues like sexual harassment against women.' The BJP in Delhi created slogans like '*Har ladki har beti kare pukar, kyon hota uski izzat par hamla baar baar. Jaagrok bano, bhajpa ko chuno* [Every girl, every daughter cries out, why is her honour attacked each time. Wake up, choose BJP]'. 'This almost sounded like a national-level campaign,' said Tikoo. 'This is no way about municipality or garbage or the sewers and the gutters. This was about the condition of women.'[89] It culminated in the BJP emerging as the single largest party in Delhi's 2012 municipal elections. In all the three councils it won, the party nominated women mayors.[90]

This early local experiment was accompanied by a national recruitment drive for the BJP's youth wing, called the Veerangana Sammelans (Women Warriors' Meetings), to specifically target younger women. Vani Tripathi Tikoo, who crafted this campaign, said, 'I targeted young women who were between eighteen to thirty-five years of age … About 70 per cent of India was under thirty years of age but there had been no targeted attempt in the party till then to change our orientation to this generational shift. The Veerangana Sammelan was born out of this realisation.'[91]

In 2009, the BJP held women-only meetings in eighteen Indian states over a six-month period. These state-level meetings focused on the eighteen to thirty-two age group and culminated in a large Veerangana Mahila Sammelan in Delhi's Mavalankar Hall. Handpicked women activists were brought to Delhi for a national leadership conclave with the party's top leadership. 'Thousands of girls travelled to Delhi for the first time for the two-day conclave which was about young women cadres alone,' explained Tikoo. Its primary aim was to provide a ready reckoner to the women on how to fight and manage election campaigns. 'We were trying to demolish that "Panch Pati" syndrome out of the Indian electoral system. Many young women leaders in that auditorium met with national leaders like Sushma Swaraj who spoke about how election management should be done … Many of them had not faced more than five men out of their ghungat before… We thought it was important to focus on the women themselves and work with them on how to learn to communicate their ideas, how to look at elections from a managerial